



KATHRYN K ACADEMY

The 90-Day Dummy Guide

Step-by-step daily setup plan with finance estimates

11 — THE 90-DAY DUMMY GUIDE

Step-by-step, day-by-day setup plan with finance estimates

(Directive Round 17, written in plain beginner language on purpose — assume zero prior business-setup knowledge)

How to use this document: Do the tasks in order. Every task lists WHO does it, WHAT it costs, WHAT you get at the end, and HOW you know it's done. Costs reference the three budgets in `06_FINANCIAL_MODEL.md` (Budget 1 = \$500–1,000, Budget 2 = \$2,500, Budget 3 = \$7,500). Do not spend Budget 3 money until the GO decision in `04_VALIDATION_PLAN.md` is actually met.



Running cost tracker (update as you go): | Phase | Days | Budget tier in use | Cumulative spend target | |---|
--|---|---| | Setup & validation launch | 1–14 | Budget 1 | ≤ \$700 | | Validation sprint runs | 15–42 | Budget 1 tail + Budget 2 | ≤ \$2,500 | | GO decision + build | 43–90 | Budget 3 (only if GO) | ≤ \$7,500 | | **Total 90-day ceiling** | |
| ≤ \$10,700 worst case; realistic path ≤ \$3,500 if STOP/IMPROVE triggers before Budget 3 |

NEXT 72 HOURS (Day 1–3)

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
1	Register/confirm domain or subdomain (e.g. kathrynmua.com/academy)	James	High	\$0–\$20	Live URL reserved	URL loads a placeholder page
2	Set up MailerLite free account	James	High	\$0	Email tool ready	Test email sent to self, received
3	Set up Carrd waitlist landing page using homepage copy from <code>10_WEBSITE_AND_FUNNEL.md</code>	James	High	\$19	Live waitlist page	Page loads, form captures a test email into MailerLite
4	Buy Canva Pro (1 month)	James	Medium	\$18	Design tool ready	Logged in, brand kit colours from <code>05_BRAND_GUIDE.md</code> added
5	Kat records 3 IG Stories polls (per <code>04_VALIDATION_PLAN.md</code> instrument 1)	Kat	High	\$0	3 published story polls	Polls live, first responses visible within 24h
6	James + Kat 30-min kickoff conversation: confirm brand name direction (Kathryn K Academy), confirm Kat is comfortable being the face	Both	High	\$0	Shared agreement on direction	Both have said yes out loud, not just assumed

Day 1–3 total spend: ≈ \$37–57

DAYS 4–7

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
7	Design waitlist page graphics + IG story templates in Canva	James/Kat	Medium	\$0 (covered)	Branded visuals	Assets saved to shared folder
8	Add waitlist link to IG bio (both accounts) and Facebook page	Kat	High	\$0	Link live in bio	Click-through works on phone
9	Post the waitlist announcement (grid post + story)	Kat	High	\$0	1 feed post, 1 story set	Post published, saves/comments tracked
10	Call or message 5 past lesson clients — ask what they'd want from a course, what they'd pay (per doc 04 instrument 1)	Kat	High	\$0	5 completed conversations, notes written down	Notes document exists with 5 entries
11	Set up ManyChat free tier for DM-keyword auto-reply ("BLUEPRINT" → waitlist link)	James	Medium	\$0	Automation live	Test DM triggers correct auto-reply
12	Draft the micro-workshop offer ("Bridal-Ready Base: 5 Mistakes") — topic, date 2–3 weeks out, price \$29–49	Kat/James	High	\$0	Workshop concept finalised	Date, price, and topic agreed in writing

Days 4–7 total spend: ≈ \$0 (reuses Canva/tools already purchased)

WEEK 2 (Days 8–14)

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
13	Buy Zoom Pro (1 month) for the workshop	James	High	\$22	Zoom account ready, >40 capacity	Test meeting hosted successfully
14	Open ticket sales for the micro-workshop (simple: Zoom registration + Stripe/PayPal link, or Eventbrite)	James	High	\$0 (Stripe % only)	Sales page live	First real ticket sold
15	Announce workshop across IG/FB, 3 posts over the week	Kat	High	\$0	3 posts published	Ticket sales visibly increasing after each post
16	Film first 2 pieces of proof-of-value content from the 100-idea bank (08_MARKETING_AND_CONTENT_SYSTEM.md)	Kat	Medium	\$0	2 Reels filmed	Footage reviewed and approved by Kat
17	Buy wireless lav mic + key light (Budget 2 items)	James	Medium	\$210	Better audio/video kit	Test recording shows clear audio, better lighting
18	Edit and post the 2 Reels	James/contractor	Medium	\$0	2 Reels live	Posted, performance tracked in a simple spreadsheet

Week 2 total spend: ≈ \$232

WEEK 3 (Days 15–21)

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
19	Continue posting per the 30-day calendar (08_MARKETING_AND_CONTENT_SYSTEM.md)	Kat	High	\$0	5 posts this week	Calendar followed, nothing skipped >1 day
20	Deliver the paid micro-workshop live	Kat	High	\$0	Workshop delivered to paying attendees	Attendee count + revenue recorded
21	Send workshop attendees a short survey: what did you like, what would you pay for more	James	Medium	\$0	Survey responses collected	≥50% response rate
22	Draft the Founding Cohort offer page for Tier 2 (10_WEBSITE_AND_FUNNEL.md template)	James	High	\$0	Draft offer page	Page reviewed and approved by Kat
23	Get 2 quotes for a solicitor contract/refund-policy review	James	Medium	\$0 (quotes free)	2 quotes in hand	Quotes compared, one selected

Week 3 total spend: ≈ \$0 (workshop is revenue-positive)

WEEK 4 (Days 22–28)

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
24	Commission the solicitor review of contract/refund templates	James	High	\$500	Reviewed templates	Solicitor sign-off received in writing
25	Open the Founding Cohort presale for Tier 2 (\$649, 25 spots)	James	High	\$0	Presale live	First founding member payment received
26	Push presale across all channels: IG, FB, email list, workshop attendees	Kat	High	\$0	Multi-channel campaign live	Daily sales tracked in spreadsheet
27	Daily DM/comment response check-in (community warmth)	Kat	High	\$0	Ongoing	Response time <24h maintained
28	Mid-presale check: are we on pace for 15+ founding members by day 42?	James	High	\$0	Go/no-go pace check	Written pace assessment against 04_VALIDATION_PLAN.md

Week 4 total spend: ≈ \$500

WEEKS 5–6 (Days 29–42) — Validation sprint closes

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
29	Continue presale push, daily content per calendar	Both	High	\$0	Sustained campaign	Waitlist and presale numbers still climbing
30	Close the Founding Cohort presale window at day 42	James	High	\$0	Final numbers locked	Total founding members + revenue counted
31	Apply the GO / IMPROVE / PIVOT / STOP decision rules exactly as written in 04_VALIDATION_PLAN.md	James	High	\$0	Written decision	Decision documented with the actual numbers behind it
32	If GO: unlock Budget 3 and begin Phase below. If IMPROVE/PIVOT/STOP: follow the doc 04 fallback instructions, do not proceed to Budget 3	Both	High	\$0	Clear next-phase direction	Decision communicated to both James and Kat explicitly

Weeks 5–6 total spend: ≈ \$0 beyond what's already spent (≈ \$732–789 cumulative so far)

DAYS 43–60 (only if GO)

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
33	Set up Thinkific account (Basic plan)	James	High	\$79/mo	Course platform live	Test module uploads successfully
34	Schedule full Tier 2 filming — 3 days blocked in Kat's calendar	Kat	High	\$0	Filming days locked in	Calendar confirmed
35	Film Tier 2 in full (12 modules, using the founding cohort as the live audience — content is taught live and recorded simultaneously)	Kat	High	\$0 (equipment already owned)	Raw footage for 12 modules	All 12 modules filmed
36	Hire contract editor for Tier 2	James	High	\$1,200	Edited course modules	First 4 modules delivered edited within 2 weeks
37	Deliver live fortnightly Q&A sessions to founding cohort as filming progresses	Kat	High	\$0	2 live sessions delivered	Attendance + engagement recorded
38	Get a public liability + professional indemnity insurance quote	James	Medium	\$0 (quote free)	Quote in hand	Written quote received
39	Begin IP Australia trademark search for "Kathryn K Academy"	James	Medium	\$0 (search free, filing later)	Search results	Search completed, risk assessed

Days 43–60 total spend: ≈ \$1,358 (+ \$158/mo ongoing Thinkific for 2 months)

DAYS 61–75

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
40	Finish editing and publish all 12 Tier 2 modules to founding cohort	James/editor	High	(covered above)	Full course live	All founding members have access
41	File the trademark application (if search came back clear)	James	Medium	\$500	Application filed	Filing receipt/reference number received
42	Purchase insurance policy	James	Medium	\$600	Active policy	Policy document on file
43	Open Tier 1 (Beginner's Blueprint) presale — build on validated momentum	James	High	\$0	Tier 1 live for sale	First Tier 1 sales recorded
44	Film Tier 1 (8 modules, ~4 hours, batch over 1–2 days)	Kat	High	\$0	Raw footage	All 8 modules filmed
45	Open Tier 3 deposit waitlist (\$100 refundable deposits, no build yet)	James	Medium	\$0	Deposit list open	First deposits received

Days 61–75 total spend: ≈ \$1,100

DAYS 76–90

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
46	Edit and publish Tier 1	James/editor	High	\$600 (partial editor allocation)	Tier 1 fully live	Public checkout works end-to-end
47	Collect founding-cohort testimonials (real, consented)	Kat	High	\$0	3–5 testimonials	Testimonials published on site with

#	Task	Owner	Priority	Est. cost	Expected output	Completion test
						consent on file
48	Review Tier 3 deposit numbers against the 8-deposit gate in 03_PRODUCT_SUITE_SPECIFICATION.md	James	High	\$0	Go/no-go on building Tier 3	Decision documented
49	Full 90-day financial review against 06_FINANCIAL_MODEL.md Scenario 1	James	High	\$0	P&L snapshot	Actual vs. estimated compared, gaps explained
50	Plan next-quarter content calendar and, if Tier 3 is a go, schedule its filming	Both	High	\$0	Quarter 2 plan	Written plan exists, dated tasks assigned

Days 76–90 total spend: ≈ \$600

90-DAY CUMULATIVE FINANCE SUMMARY

Phase	Spend range
Days 1–42 (setup + validation)	≈ \$732–789
Days 43–90 (build, only if GO)	≈ \$3,058
Total if GO at day 42	≈ \$3,800–3,850
Total if STOP/IMPROVE at day 42	≈ \$732–789 (Budget 3 never touched)

Both outcomes land comfortably under the \$7,500 Budget 3 ceiling — the plan is designed so that a STOP decision costs under \$800, not thousands, protecting James and Kat from unnecessary financial loss exactly as the original brief requires.